

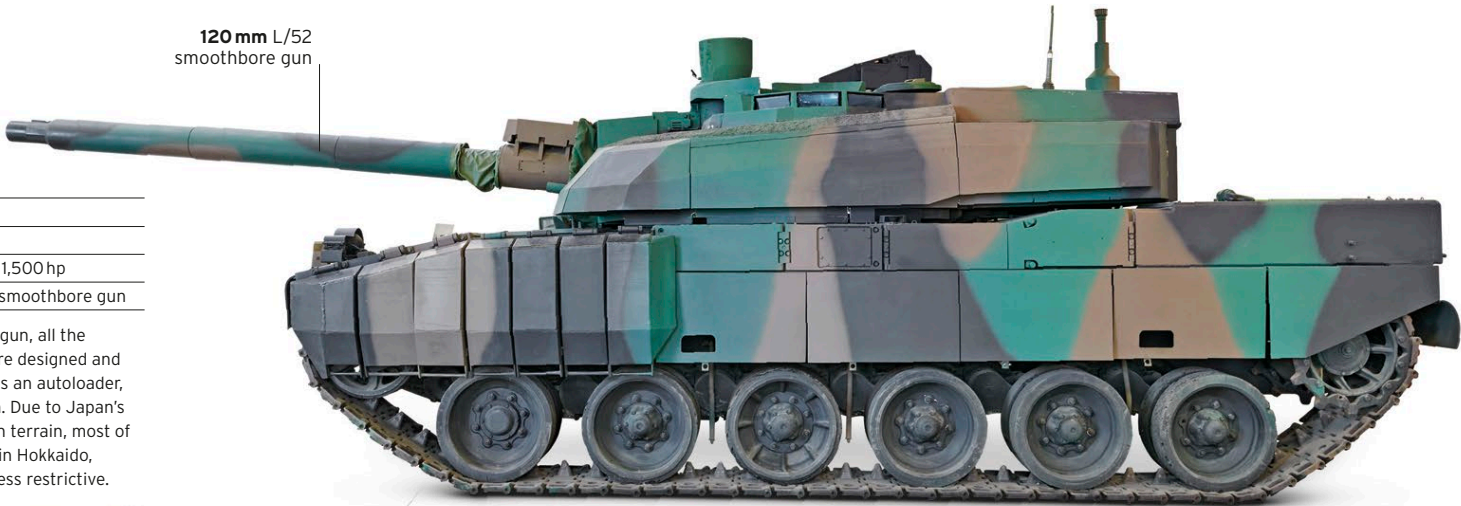
Post-Cold War Tanks

The end of the Cold War slowed down the development of tanks, but by no means ended it. Former adversaries reduced the size of their militaries, selling or scrapping many vehicles as such large armies were no longer needed. Many vehicles that were under development during the late 1980s were brought into service slowly and in small numbers. On the other hand, some existing tanks continued to receive upgrades, such as the introduction of the L/55 120 mm gun mounted on the German Leopard 2A6.



△	M1A2 Abrams
Date	1992
Country	USA
Weight	69.4 tons (63 tonnes)
Engine	Textron Lycoming AGT1500 gas turbine, 1,500 hp
Main armament	120 mm M256 L/44 smoothbore gun

Introduced in 1985, the M1A1 had a more effective 120 mm gun than the M1 and an improved suspension and transmission, while the M1A2 added a Commander's Independent Thermal Viewer (CITV), enabling the commander to look in a different direction from the gunner. Experience in the Gulf also led to enhancements, especially to the electronics and computer systems.



120 mm L/52 smoothbore gun

▽	Type 90
Date	1991
Country	Japan
Weight	55.1 tons (50 tonnes)
Engine	Mitsubishi 10ZG diesel, 1,500 hp
Main armament	120 mm L/44 smoothbore gun

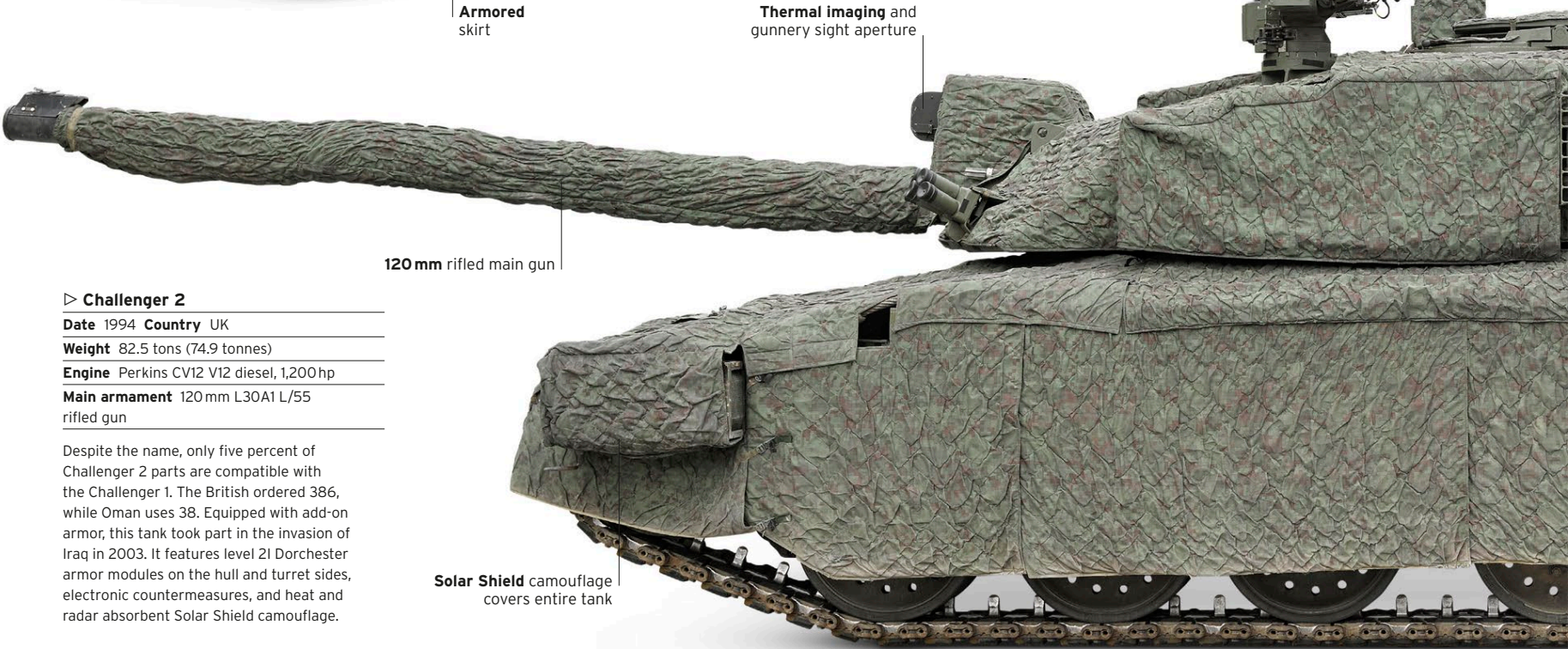
With the exception of the main gun, all the components of the Type 90 were designed and built in Japan. The tank features an autoloader, reducing the crew to three men. Due to Japan's difficult mountainous and urban terrain, most of the 341 Type 90s are deployed in Hokkaido, where their size and weight is less restrictive.



Armored skirt

△	Leclerc
Date	1992
Country	France
Weight	62.3 tons (56.5 tonnes)
Engine	Wartsila V8X T9 diesel, 1,500 hp
Main armament	120 mm CN120-26 L/52 smoothbore gun

The Leclerc replaced the much lighter AMX-30. A total of 406 were built for France and 388 for the United Arab Emirates (UAE). An autoloader has reduced its crew to three. The electronics and armor have been steadily improved across production batches. French Leclercs have been used for peacekeeping in Kosovo and Lebanon, and the UAE's tanks have seen service in Yemen.



Thermal imaging and gunnery sight aperture

120 mm rifled main gun

▷	Challenger 2
Date	1994
Country	UK
Weight	82.5 tons (74.9 tonnes)
Engine	Perkins CV12 V12 diesel, 1,200 hp
Main armament	120 mm L30A1 L/55 rifled gun

Despite the name, only five percent of Challenger 2 parts are compatible with the Challenger 1. The British ordered 386, while Oman uses 38. Equipped with add-on armor, this tank took part in the invasion of Iraq in 2003. It features level 21 Dorchester armor modules on the hull and turret sides, electronic countermeasures, and heat and radar absorbent Solar Shield camouflage.

Solar Shield camouflage covers entire tank